Moderating Effect of Personality and the Relationship Between Proximity-Based Among Peers and Self-Confidence

Senior High School Department Tomas
Cabili National High School
Iligan City, Philippines

FELISCENT SHAYNE A. ANTIDO
JONATHAN V. PADAYHAG. Jr
KENT BRYAN A. PALARAO
CHESKA B. CABANDAY
JELAIKA A. MORATO
MARK T. CLARABAL
JOHN ZHASKI A. LAI
CRISH F. CANOY

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MODERATING EFFECT OF PERSONALITY AND THE RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN PROXIMITY-BASED AMONG PEERS AND SELF-CONFIDENCE

A Research Study

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of the Requirements for the

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by

FELISCENT SHAYNE A. ANTIDO
JONATHAN V. PADAYHAG. Jr
KENT BRYAN A. PALARAO
CHESKA B. CABANDAY
JELAIKA A. MORATO
MARK T. CLARABAL
JOHN ZHASKI A. LAI
CRISH F. CANOY

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DEDICATION

This study is dedicated to,

The students of Tomas Cabili National High School.

For willingly participating in our study.

Moreover, this study is also encouraged by our advisor, Sir Jonathan R. Paler, PhD.

This study would not have been conducted without the support of our families, schoolmates, classmates, and the group of this research.

We dedicate this research to our fathers for supporting us in our journey in this research; without them, we would have been lost in our study.

We also dedicate this research to our mothers for giving us the love we need to continue to do this study and the courage to face challenges.

And lastly, We dedicate this research paper to the almighty God who gives me strength, wisdom, guidance, and power. We thank God for keeping us healthy in this research.

CFC, CBC, FSAA, JZL,
JAM, KBP, JVP,
MTC

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ABSTRACT

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Researchers	-	Crish F. Canoy, John Zhaski A. Lai, Feliscent Shayne A. Antido, Kent Bryan A. Palarao, Cheska B. Cabanday, Jelaika A. Morato, Jonathan V. Padayhag. Jr, Mark T. Clarabal
Adviser	-	Jonathan R. Paler, PhD
School	-	Tomas Cabilli National High School Brgy. Tomas Cabili, Iligan City
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This study investigated the relationship between proximity-based peer interactions and the self-confidence of senior high school students, alongside the moderating role of the Big Five personality traits. Utilizing a quantitative correlational design, the research surveyed 40 Grade 12 students from Tomas Cabili National High School using Fishbowl Sampling. Data was gathered using a structured Likert-scale questionnaire and analyzed via Pearson correlation and hierarchical moderation analysis. Findings revealed an extremely strong, positive correlation ($r = 0.9736$, $p = 0.026$) between peer proximity and student self-confidence. Furthermore, personality significantly moderated this baseline relationship. Openness, Conscientiousness, and Agreeableness functioned as highly significant positive amplifiers, while Neuroticism altered the degree to which students relied on close peer networks for psychological stability. Extraversion, however, yielded no significant moderating effect. The study concludes that physical and social closeness among supportive peers fundamentally drives student self-confidence, though the magnitude and nature of this effect are heavily dictated by individual personality structures.

Keywords: Proximity-Based, Self-Confidence, Big Five Personality Traits Moderating Effect, Peer Interaction, Peer Support, Quantitative Correlational Design.

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Chapter 1

THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE

Background of the Study

Peer relationships play an important role in the development of students' self-confidence, especially during adolescence when social interactions become more influential. Students who frequently interact with supportive and encouraging peers are more likely to develop positive self-perceptions and greater confidence in expressing themselves both academically and socially.

According to Panwar and Gorsy (2016), there is a significant association between peer relationships and self-confidence among adolescents. Similarly, Bishop and Inderbitzen (1995) found that students with close friendships tend to exhibit higher levels of self-esteem and confidence. Furthermore, recent studies have shown that positive peer acceptance and social support contribute to the enhancement of students' self-confidence and overall well-being (Chaira & Taufik, 2025). Therefore, examining the relationship between proximity-based peer among peers and self-confidence among senior high school students can provide valuable

insights into how social interactions within the school environment influence students' personal development.

Consequently, this investigation focuses on establishing whether a statistically significant relationship exists among proximity-based among peers, peer personality characteristics, and the self-confidence of senior high school students at Tomas Cabili National High School. To achieve this, the study measures the level of proximity-based among peers across three specific dimensions: peer interaction, peer support, and peer influence.

Concurrently, it explores the personality of the peers specifically looking at traits like extraversion, agreeableness, and emotional stability to determine how a peer’s distinct behavioral disposition shapes their social impact. This is then mapped against student self-confidence in terms of academic confidence, social confidence, and emotional confidence. Previous literature suggests that positive peer interactions and supportive friendships substantially contribute to the development of self-confidence and self-esteem among adolescents (Wentzel, 2017).

However, the effectiveness of these interactions is heavily dependent on the personality of the peers involved, as distinct peer traits can either uplift or diminish a student’s emotional well-being and assurance in

academic and social settings (Ryan, 2001). By systematically investigating these three interwoven variables, this study seeks to provide a deeper, more comprehensive understanding of how proximity-based among peers and peer personalities in relation to students' self-confidence.

Theoretical Framework

The baseline path of this framework establishes a direct relationship between the independent variable, proximity-based peer relationships, and the dependent variable, self-confidence, by synthesizing Bibb Latané's Social Impact Theory with Jan Stets' and Peter Burke's Identity Theory. Social Impact Theory asserts that social influence is determined by a group's strength, number, and immediacy, meaning that proximity-based peers wield significant influence due to their constant physical or psychological closeness.

Concurrently, Identity Theory posits that self-confidence is a dynamic outcome of social interaction, sustained when individuals successfully fulfill social roles and achieve identity verification through external validation because proximate peers hold high social immediacy, they function as a continuous source of environmental feedback that either verifies or disrupts an individual's identity, directly driving subsequent fluctuations in self-confidence (Burke & Stets, 2012).

To account for individual variances, the Five-Factor Model of personality is introduced as a moderating variable that filters this baseline relationship. While Social Impact Theory dictates the magnitude of external social pressure and Identity Theory explains the internal processing of validation, the Five-Factor Model functions as a psychological lens that can amplify or dilute these forces based on stable individual traits. For instance, individuals high in Extraversion or Agreeableness are naturally oriented toward external groups, rendering them highly receptive to peer environments and making the relationship between peer proximity and self-confidence particularly pronounced. Conversely, high Neuroticism increases sensitivity to social threats, meaning peer proximity could destabilize identity verification if feedback is perceived as negative. Meanwhile, highly Conscientious or Open individuals tend to rely on internal metrics for self-evaluation, which effectively dampens the psychological impact of immediate peer presence (Costa & McCrae, 1999).

Successfully integrating these constructs requires reconciling their disparate theoretical assumptions and paradigms. Social Impact Theory stems from behavioral psychology, viewing actions as predictable responses to external, situational forces, whereas the Five-Factor Model

originates from trait psychology, focusing on stable, internal, and biologically driven predispositions. Bridging these external and internal viewpoints is Identity Theory, rooted in structural symbolic interactionism within sociology, which examines the fluid self-concept built through interactive feedback loops.

Rather than viewing these perspectives as contradictory, this framework synthesizes them into a cohesive narrative: proximity-based peer relationships (Social Impact Theory) provide the immediate environmental feedback necessary for identity verification (Identity Theory), but the ultimate trajectory and strength of this relationship are governed by the individual's inherent personality traits (Five-Factor Model).

Conceptual Framework

This study is conceptualized from the integration of Bibb Latané's Social Impact Theory, Cast and Burke's Identity Theory, and the Five-Factor Model of Personality of Lewis Goldberg. These theories collectively explain how proximity-based peer relationships influence students' self-confidence and how personality shapes this relationship.

Drawing from Social Impact Theory, proximity-based peer relationships are considered the independent variable because students who interact frequently with peers experience greater social influence due to their physical and psychological closeness. This influence is reflected through peer interaction, peer support, and peer influence, which represent the dimensions of proximity-based peer relationships. As proposed by the theory, peers who are more immediate and constantly present have a stronger capacity to affect an individual's attitudes, behaviors, and perceptions.

Guided by Identity Theory, self-confidence is identified as the dependent variable. The theory suggests that individuals continuously develop and evaluate their self-concept through interactions with others. Positive feedback, acceptance, and validation from nearby peers strengthen identity verification, leading to higher levels of academic confidence, social confidence, and personal confidence. Conversely, negative peer interactions may weaken identity verification and reduce students' confidence.

To further explain individual differences, the study incorporates the Five-Factor Model of Personality as the moderating variable. Personality is measured through the dimensions of Openness, Conscientiousness,

Extraversion, Agreeableness, and Neuroticism. Rather than directly influencing self-confidence, personality is expected to determine how strongly proximity-based peer relationships affect students' confidence. Students with high levels of Extraversion and Agreeableness may benefit more from supportive peer environments because they are naturally more receptive to social interactions. In contrast, students with higher Neuroticism may become more vulnerable to negative peer experiences, weakening the positive influence of peer proximity. Likewise, students high in Conscientiousness or Openness may rely more on their personal values and internal standards, reducing their dependence on peer validation.

Based on these theoretical foundations, the conceptual framework proposes that proximity-based peer relationships directly influence students' self-confidence, while personality moderates the strength and direction of this relationship. In other words, the effect of peer interaction, peer support, and peer influence on students' academic, social, and personal confidence is expected to vary according to the individual's personality traits.

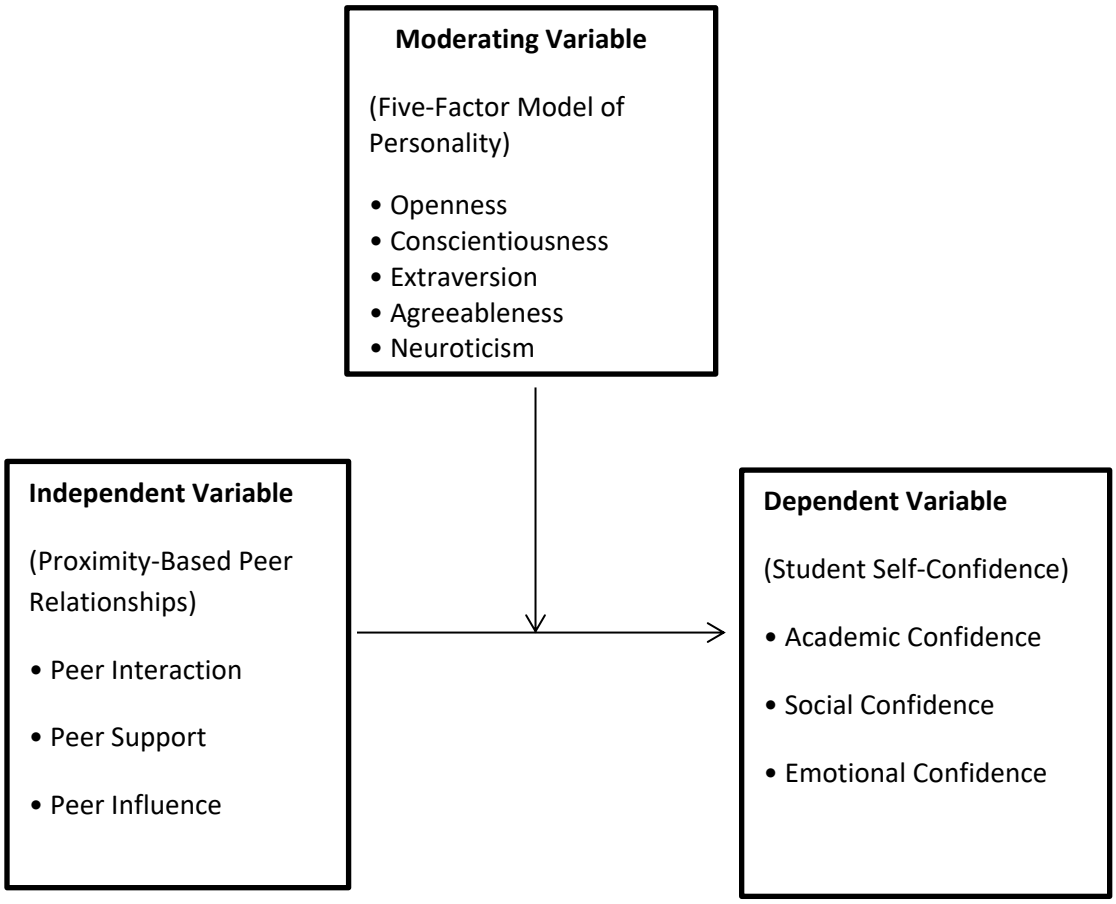


Figure A: The Schematic Diagram showing the Interplay of Variables of the Study

Statement of the Problem

The main purpose of this study is to find out whether proximity-based among peers and self-confidence has a relationship, and whether personality has a role has an effect of being the moderating variable in both independent and dependent variable's relationship. It also aims to let students know how to boost their academic confidence, social confidence, and personal confidence by surrounding themselves in encouraging peers. Specifically, this study sought to answer the following questions:

1. What is the profile of the student respondents in terms of:
    1.1 Proximity-Based Peer Relationship:
        a. Peer Interaction;
        b. Peer Support; and
        c. Peer Influence?
    1.2 Students' Confidence:
        a) Academic Confidence;
        b) Social Confidence; and
        c) Emotional Confidence?
    1.3 Personality Traits:
        a. Openness;
        b. Conscientiousness;

c. Extraversion;

d. Agreeableness; and

e. Neuroticism?

2. Is there a significant relationship between proximity-based peer relationships and a student's self-confidence?

3. Is there a moderating effect of personality on the relationship between proximity-based peer relationships and student's self-confidence?

Null Hypotheses

From the foregoing statement of the problem, the following null hypotheses will be tested:

Ho_1: There is no significant relationship between proximity-based among peer and self-confidence.

Ho_2: Personality does not significantly moderate the relationship between proximity-based peer interactions and self-confidence.

Significance

This study which examines how the Moderating Effect of Personality and the Relationship Between Proximity-Based Among Peers and Self Confidence will benefit the following:

Senior High School Students. This study will help the possible effect of immediate social circles and seating arrangements or physical proximity in school affect in their self-esteem. By being aware of this, students may make conscious choices to surround themselves with supportive peers who boost their confidence.

Teachers and School Administrators. This study will provide data-driven insights into classroom management. If proximity significantly affects confidence, teachers can strategically design seating arrangements or group activities to pair anxious or low-confidence students with encouraging peers, creating a more inclusive learning environment.

School Guidance Counselors. The counselors may use the findings of this study to develop targeted intervention programs or peer-support groups. In understanding the possible influences of proximity to self-confidence may allow them to address isolation effectively among SHS students.

Parents. This study may offer parents a clearer picture of how their children's peer may affect their emotional well-being. This may guide the parents in supporting their children's friendships and social habits inside and outside of school.

Future Researchers. This study may serve as a valuable reference or baseline literature for researchers studying educational psychology, student dynamics, or adolescent behavior. This opens doors to explore related variables, such as the effect of virtual proximity (online interactions) on self-confidence.

Scope and Delimitations

This study aims to examine the moderating effect of personality on the relationship between proximity-based interactions among peers and the self-confidence of students at Tomas Cabili National High School (TCNHS). The respondents will consist of selected Senior High School students enrolled at Tomas Cabili National High School during the School Year 2026–2027. Data will be gathered through validated survey questionnaires to measure students' personality traits, peer proximity, and level of self-confidence.

The study will be limited only to students of Tomas Cabili National High School and will not include students from other schools or educational institutions. It will focus only on the variables of personality, proximity-based peer interactions, and self-confidence. Other factors that may influence self-confidence, such as parenting style, academic achievement, socioeconomic status, social media exposure, and psychological well-being, are excluded from the study.

Definition of Terms

For better understanding of the discussion in the succeeding chapters, the key concepts are defined conceptually or operationally:

Personality. It is the unique patterns of thoughts, feelings, and behaviors that characterize an individual. In this study, it refers to the Big Five Personality Traits Openness, Conscientiousness, Extraversion, Agreeableness, and Neuroticism of Goldberg which may influence the relationship between proximity-based peer relationships and students' self-confidence.

Proximity-Based Peer Relationships. It is the closeness and frequency of interactions among students who regularly spend time together in the school environment. In this study, this refers to the variable which

includes peer interaction, peer support, and peer influence as its dimensions that will be tested for possible relationship with self-confidence.

Peer Interaction. It is the communication, collaboration, and social activities that occur among students. In this study, it describes the frequency and quality of interactions students have with their classmates and friends within the school setting.

Peer Support. It is the emotional, academic, and social assistance that students receive from their peers. In this study, it is considered a factor that may enhance students' self-confidence through encouragement, guidance, and positive reinforcement.

Peer Influence. It is the effect that friends and classmates have on a student's attitudes, behaviors, beliefs, and decisions. In this study, it is one of the dimensions of proximity-based peer relationships that may influence students' self-confidence.

Self-Confidence. It is a student's belief in their own abilities, skills, and judgment to accomplish tasks and face different situations. In this study, it is the dependent variable and is measured in terms of students' confidence in academic, social, and personal situations.

Neuroticism. It is a personality trait characterized by a tendency to experience negative emotions such as anxiety, worry, sadness, and emotional instability. In this study, it measures how a student's level of neuroticism influences the relationship between proximity-based peer relationships and self-confidence.

Extraversion. It is a personality trait characterized by sociability, assertiveness, enthusiasm, and a preference for interacting with others. In this study, it examines how a student's level of extraversion, particularly their willingness to engage with peers, influences the relationship between proximity-based peer relationships and self-confidence.

Openness. It is a personality trait characterized by curiosity, imagination, creativity, and a willingness to experience new ideas and situations. In this study, it measures how a student's level of openness influences the relationship between proximity-based peer relationships and self-confidence.

Conscientiousness. It is a personality trait characterized by responsibility, organization, self-discipline, and goal-oriented behavior. In this study, it examines how a student's level of conscientiousness influences

the relationship between proximity-based peer relationships and self-confidence.

Agreeableness. It is a personality trait characterized by kindness, compassion, cooperativeness, trust, and consideration for others. In this study, it measures how a student's level of agreeableness influences the relationship between proximity-based peer relationships and self-confidence.

Chapter 2

REVIEW OF RELATED LITERATURE

This chapter presents the different studies and readings which will be presumed significant and related to the current study.

Related Literatures

Adolescent self-confidence is heavily negotiated within immediate social circles, where daily interactions with proximity-based peers serve as a primary testing ground for identity. According to Meliala et al (2026), this foundational value mandates communication marked by humility, politeness, emotional self-control, and a deliberate lowering of oneself to show respect. By demonstrating how personality traits act as a pivotal moderator in the relationship between proximity-based peer communication and adolescent self-confidence. Within the immediate peer group, adherence to localized communication norms which prioritizes politeness, humility, and interaction presents a complex, dual-effect on self-evaluation. On one hand, adopting these peer communication norms fosters social harmony and peer acceptance, directly enhancing an adolescent's self-confidence.

The relationship between proximity-based interactions and self-confidence is highly evident during collaborative development phases, where close peer networks provide the experiential framework for self-evaluation. Evans and Cloutier (2026) demonstrates that structured relationship-based communication and shared group experiences within a programmatic cohort are crucial drivers for personal transformation, allowing individuals to overcome challenges and build robust self-confidence. When individuals are placed in close continuous proximity with a supportive peer group the shared journey acts as a powerful catalyst for developing professional self-efficacy and resilience.

Yet, the extent to which these proximity-based peer dynamics successfully translate into personal confidence is heavily moderated by personality traits. An individual with high emotional stability and a proactive personality type will seamlessly leverage these proximal peer challenges to build authoritative self-confidence, whereas an individual prone to self-doubt may view the exact same close-contact peer environment as an intimidating space, proving that internal personality traits filter external social or benefits.

Career aspirations refer to an individual's long-term professional goals and ambitions, influenced not only by internal personality traits and values but also by external social contexts. Drawing from key psychological frameworks such as Festinger's Social Comparison Theory (1954), Bandura's Social Learning Theory (1977), and Bandura's Self Efficacy Theory (1986), by exploring how peer interactions, perceived social evaluations, and internal self-beliefs collectively influence the pursuit of career success. Participants who reported higher levels of peer influence and greater tendencies to compare themselves with others were more likely to have elevated career ambitions.

Notably, self-confidence emerged as a strong predictor of career success aspirations. It played a crucial moderating role by buffering the negative impacts of excessive peer influence and upward social comparison. In other words, individuals with higher self-confidence maintained ambitious career goals even when exposed to potentially detrimental social pressures. These findings affirm that while social environments are influential, personal belief in one's capabilities can significantly enhance resilience and motivation.

Peer interaction is widely recognized as a significant factor in shaping an individual's self-confidence and overall psychological well-being.

Frequent face-to-face interactions with classmates and friends provide opportunities for emotional support, cooperation, and shared learning experiences, which contribute to the development of positive self-perceptions and confidence.

According to Lev Vygotsky (1978), social interaction serves as a fundamental component of cognitive and psychological development. Through his Social Development Theory, Vygotsky explained that individuals acquire knowledge, skills, and confidence by engaging in meaningful interactions with more knowledgeable others and their peers. These collaborative experiences encourage learners to express their thoughts, solve problems collectively, and actively participate in academic and social activities, thereby fostering greater self-confidence and personal growth.

Peer-proximity can directly influence the fine line between developing self-confidence or developing emotional distress. Imomaliyeva (2026) notes that negative or unstable socio-psychological factors within an individual's immediate environment can easily facilitate the formation of intense social anxiety, which directly undermines and deteriorates core self-confidence. When the daily communication style among close, proximal peers is characterized by exclusion, high pressure, or harsh evaluation, it triggers

chronic self-doubt and emotional instability. This destructive relationship is strongly moderated by individual personality traits, as individuals high in neuroticism or possessing sensitive temperaments are far more vulnerable to internalizing environmental stressors. Consequently, while proximity to peers establishes the initial socio-psychological baseline for communication, an individual's distinct personality traits dictate whether those close interactions ultimately cultivate strong self-confidence or induce paralyzing social anxiety.

Related Studies

Modeling students' academic confidence, personality and academic emotions

The study conducted by Sander and de la Fuente (2020) in a higher education setting within Spain analyzed the intricate relationships between university students' personality traits, academic behavioral confidence, and achievement-related emotions. Published in 2020, the research utilized Structural Equation Modeling (SEM) to demonstrate that Big Five personality traits serve as powerful, distal predictors of a student's confidence levels. Specifically, the researchers found that traits such as Conscientiousness,

Extraversion, Agreeableness, and Openness have significant, direct positive correlations with academic confidence, whereas Neuroticism exerts a strong negative influence. Furthermore, their findings revealed that these personality dispositions do not dictate confidence in a vacuum, but rather interact continuously with a student's internal emotional states when facing academic challenges. This establishes that structural personal traits act as fundamental anchors determining how an individual evaluates their own capabilities in response to their immediate environment.

Despite these insights, several distinct gaps remain. First, Sander and de la Fuente (2020) focused almost exclusively on internal psychological mechanisms, leaving a significant gap regarding spatial or localized social factors, such as proximity-based among peers (e.g., physical seating closeness or immediate peer environments). Second, while the reference study positioned personality traits strictly as predictors of confidence, it did not explore how these traits might function as an external buffer or amplifier. By failing to evaluate personality as an explicit moderator between an external environmental stimulus like physical peer proximity and an internal outcome like self-confidence, the existing literature leaves open a critical pathway that your study directly addresses.

Incidence and occurrence of academic burnout: The impact of personality, self-efficacy and self-esteem and post-pandemic effects

A study conducted by Morando et al. (2023) at a university setting in Italy analyzed the psychological factors influencing academic burnout among a total sample of 609 university students. Published in 2023, the research utilized a multiple-mediation model to compare student experiences across two distinct phases: the height of the COVID-19 pandemic and the subsequent post-pandemic recovery period. The key findings of the study established that certain Big Five personality traits, specifically conscientiousness, act as strong predictors in the direct management of academic burnout.

Furthermore, the researchers highlighted that internal psychological resources namely self-efficacy and self-esteem act as powerful protective mechanisms that mitigate feelings of inadequacy and support students through changing educational demands. When contextualized within the post-pandemic landscape, these findings demonstrate that internal self-belief and structured personality dispositions act as crucial anchors for managing stress when external environmental setups change rapidly.

Despite these vital contributions, several critical gaps remain. First, while Morando et al. (2023) focused heavily on macro-environmental shifts

(the transition from online pandemic restrictions to post-pandemic return), they omitted micro-spatial and localized physical factors, such as proximity-based among peers (e.g., immediate physical workspace closeness or classroom seating proximity). This leaves an empirical gap regarding how day-to-day physical layout and close peer proximity influence a student's confidence. Second, the study focused on self-efficacy and self-esteem primarily as direct protective barriers against burnout rather than focusing explicitly on self-confidence as the core dependent variable.

Lastly, the researchers positioned personality as a direct predictor within a mediation model, leaving open a vital theoretical path: testing whether personality traits function as an explicit moderator that alters, buffers, or amplifies the relationship between an immediate external social stimulus (such as proximity-based peers) and a student's overarching self-confidence.

Personality, peer relations, and self-confidence as predictors of happiness and loneliness

A study conducted by Cheng and Furnham (2002) at the Department of Psychology, University College London in the United Kingdom, examined the degree to which individual differences predict subjective well-being in young demographics. Published in 2002, the research utilized

comprehensive regression and correlation analyses to evaluate how personality traits, friendship/peer relations, and self-confidence directly determine an individual's self-rated happiness and felt loneliness. The key findings established that personality traits (specifically extraversion and neuroticism) are direct, fundamental predictors of both happiness and self-confidence.

Furthermore, the study revealed that extraversion plays a pivotal role in shaping an individual's general confidence and subsequent social interactions, which in turn significantly lower perceived loneliness. Ultimately, their findings demonstrated that peer-related social networks and individual self-confidence operate concurrently as critical psychological resources that buffer against negative emotional states.

Despite these vital contributions, several significant gaps exist. While the referenced study established a clear statistical relationship between peer interaction and self-confidence, it treated personality primarily as a direct antecedent or linear predictor of these outcomes. It failed to investigate whether personality traits could act as an explicit structural moderator that shapes, stabilizes, or alters how a student responds to their physical peer environment.

The Influence of Personality, Parental Behaviors, and Self-Esteem on Internet Addiction: A Study of Chinese College Students

A study conducted across five major cities in China examined the external environmental and internal psychological determinants that contribute to internet addiction among a large sample of 2,095 Chinese college students. Published in 2014, the research used path analysis and hierarchical regression models to assess how personality traits (specifically psychoticism and neuroticism), varying parental behaviors, and individual self-esteem collectively predict behavioral outcomes. The key findings established that personality traits act as potent direct predictors of individual maladaptive behaviors, while negative external environments such as paternal overprotection or maternal rejection significantly increase behavioral risks.

Most notably, the study revealed that positive environmental stimuli, such as emotional warmth from parents, help mitigate behavioral issues by being partially mediated through the development of the students' self-esteem. This ultimately demonstrates that an individual’s internal self-evaluation and structured personality profiles dictate how they internalize and react to the pressures exerted by their immediate social or familial environments.

Despite these insights, several distinct gaps arise when analyzing this text. First, the reference study focuses extensively on familial structures (parental behaviors), leaving a significant gap regarding the micro-spatial and immediate social environments encountered in daily college life, such as proximity-based among peers (e.g., physical seating layouts, laboratory proximity, or localized peer groups).

Finally, the researchers positioned personality traits strictly as direct linear predictors or antecedents of problematic outcomes within their path models. This leaves open a critical theoretical pathway: evaluating whether personality traits instead function as an explicit, structural moderator that buffers, alters, or accentuates how a student's self-confidence responds to immediate, physical proximity-based peer environments.

Socio-economic differences in self-esteem of adolescents influenced by personality, mental health and social support

A cross-sectional study conducted among 3,694 elementary-school students in Slovakia investigated how intrapersonal, interpersonal, and socio-cultural factors impact adolescent self-esteem across different financial demographics. Published online in late 2009 and compiled into the journal's 2010 volume, the research used hierarchical linear regression to assess the mechanisms connecting socioeconomic status, specifically

family affluence, to a child's psychological self-view. The key findings established that personality dimensions (namely extraversion, emotional stability, and openness to experience), strong mental health, and perceived social support from family or significant others are positively associated with high self-esteem.

Crucially, the researchers determined that an individual's core personality traits and immediate social layers serve as vital internal anchors that actively contribute to, shape, and explain the relationship between a person's physical environment (such as family affluence or structural social position) and their resulting self-belief.

Despite these insightful parameters, several critical gaps emerge when filtering this literature. First, while Veselska et al. (2010) focused extensively on macro-environmental factors (family affluence and socioeconomic background), they left a major gap regarding micro-spatial environmental metrics, such as proximity-based among peers (e.g., localized peer groups, immediate physical workspace setups, or classroom seating proximity). Second, although the study noted that social support from "significant others" impacts self-esteem, it relied on global perceptions of social connection rather than measuring physical, localized peer closeness. Finally, the researchers evaluated personality dimensions as

direct predictors or contributing mechanisms within a linear path to self-esteem, rather than examining personality as an explicit structural moderator. Their model leaves open a vital theoretical avenue: testing whether personality traits act as a buffer or amplifier that actively moderates how an external spatial stimulus such as the physical proximity of peers shapes a student's self-confidence.

Personality Correlates of Self-Esteem

A massive web-based study conducted by Robins et al. (2001) examined the structural relationship between global self-esteem and the Big Five personality dimensions using a large, heterogeneous international sample of 326,641 individuals ranging from ages 9 to 90. Published in 2001, the research utilized hierarchical regression and correlation analyses across diverse demographic groups to observe how core personality configurations map onto self-evaluation. The key findings established that the Big Five personality dimensions collectively account for a substantial 34% of the variance in self-esteem, showing that high self-esteem individuals are consistently characterized as emotionally stable (low neuroticism), extraverted, and conscientious, while being moderately agreeable and open to experience.

Crucially, the researchers tested an extensive array of potential mediators and moderators across age, sex, social class, ethnicity, and nationality, proving that the underlying ties between a person's core personality traits and their baseline self-beliefs remain largely robust, universal, and cross-cutting regardless of external demographic boundaries.

Despite the foundational strength of these findings, several distinct gaps arise when analyzing this text. First, because Robins et al. (2001) captured data through an expansive internet-based survey to build a macro-level demographic overview, they left a significant gap regarding localized, micro-spatial environmental metrics, such as proximity-based among peers (e.g., immediate classroom seating arrangements, physical workspace layout, or physical closeness to peer support networks). Second, while the study establishes a powerful baseline link between personality and self-evaluation, it conceptualized self-esteem as a global, static disposition rather than isolating self-confidence as a situational behavioral outcome that fluctuates under local social pressures. Finally, the researchers explicitly searched for external variables that might moderate the relationship between personality and self-beliefs, finding none; however, they did not explore the reverse theoretical path. Their model leaves open a critical pathway: testing whether internal personality traits function as an explicit

structural moderator that buffers, amplifies, or alters how a student's self-confidence responds to immediate, physical proximity-based peer environments.

The Role of Self-Confidence in Personality Development: An Observational Study of Baku

An observational study conducted by Aslanli (2025) across secondary schools in Baku, Azerbaijan, explored how school settings shape the psychological growth of young learners. Carried out between February and May 2025, the research utilized qualitative classroom observations, diagnostic tests, and individual counseling sessions to analyze the structural relationship between adolescent self-confidence and overall personality development. The key findings established that self-confidence functions as a foundational psychological resource that actively steers identity formation and emotional stability, rather than acting as a static trait. Crucially, the researcher highlighted that peer influence, school relations, and immediate classroom environments serve as primary external anchors that heavily dictate whether a student struggles with social anxiety and low self-esteem or develops personal resilience. Ultimately, the study demonstrated that a student's self-confidence is inherently responsive to localized social dynamics and peer interactions within the school ecosystem.

Despite these insightful observations, several distinct gaps arise when analyzing this research. First, while Aslanli (2025) acknowledged the broad impact of peer influence, the study relied on general qualitative reflections of social dynamics, leaving a significant empirical gap regarding micro-spatial and localized physical factors, such as proximity-based among peers (e.g., physical classroom seating closeness or immediate workspace proximity). Second, although the research noted that self-confidence is central to personality development, it positioned self-confidence primarily as a precursor to broad identity outcomes rather than isolating it as the central dependent variable shaped by physical social proximity. Finally, the study treated personality development as a broad, ongoing outcome of environmental experiences, omitting any quantitative exploration of personality traits as explicit, structural moderators. The existing model leaves open a vital theoretical avenue: testing whether fixed individual personality traits function as a buffer or amplifier that actively alters how a student's self-confidence reacts to the immediate physical presence of their peers.

Synthesis

The reviewed literature collectively establishes that an adolescent's internal self-evaluation is not formed in a vacuum, but is instead

shaped by a continuous interplay between immediate social environments and inherent psychological structures. Across both cultural frameworks and structured developmental programs, proximal social interactions and peer relationships serve as primary testing grounds for identity, behavior reinforcement, and personal transformation. Positive relational climates such as the receipt of praise or participation in collaborative cohorts foster personal security, professional self-efficacy, and resilience. Conversely, immediate environments characterized by high pressure, strict cultural conformity, or social exclusion can induce severe emotional distress, chronic self-doubt, and paralyzing social anxiety.

While the external peer environment establishes the baseline for daily communication, the literature consistently points to individual personality traits as the critical lens filtering these social experiences. For instance, structured or highly active peer dynamics do not affect all individuals uniformly; extraverted or emotionally stable individuals frequently leverage close-contact peer settings to build authoritative confidence, whereas introverted, highly agreeable, or neurotic individuals may experience energy depletion, heightened self-consciousness, or severe social fatigue in the exact same environments. This divergence underscores that internal personality dispositions actively dictate whether close social contact

ultimately cultivates robust self-confidence or triggers psychological withdrawal.

Despite these insights, several distinct empirical gaps remain across the existing studies. The current body of literature focuses heavily on either macro-environmental factors, such as family affluence and post-pandemic transitions, or broad qualitative assessments of peer influence. Consequently, there is a notable omission of micro-spatial, localized physical metrics, such as physical classroom seating closeness, laboratory proximity, or immediate physical workspace layouts.

Furthermore, previous quantitative models have traditionally treated personality traits strictly as direct linear predictors or antecedents of self-evaluation. By failing to evaluate personality dimensions as explicit structural moderators, the existing literature leaves open a critical theoretical pathway. The present quantitative study directly addresses these gaps by investigating whether fixed individual personality traits function as a structural buffer or amplifier that actively moderates the relationship between a physical, proximity-based peer environment and an adolescent's overarching self-confidence.

Chapter 3

RESEARCH METHODS

This chapter presents the research methods used in the study. It also discusses the research design, research environment, respondents, sampling procedures, research instruments, data gathering, and statistical treatment of the data.

Research Design

This study used a quantitative correlational research design. This research design was appropriate because it aimed to determine the relationship between proximity-based among peers and self-confidence among Grade 12 students. The quantitative approach allowed the researchers to collect numerical data through a structured questionnaire and analyze it using statistical methods. The correlational design helped determine whether a significant relationship exists between the two variables without manipulating them. In addition, the study examined whether personality, based on the Big Five Personality Traits, moderates the relationship between proximity-based among peers and students' self-confidence.

Research Locale

The study was conducted at Tomas Cabili National High School (TCNHS) in Iligan City, Lanao del Norte. Established in 1971, TCNHS is one of the leading public secondary schools in the city. The school has an estimated student population of approximately 2,000 students, offering quality education to learners from different academic strands and grade levels. It was chosen as the research locale because it has a sufficient population of Senior High School students who can provide reliable and relevant information for the study. Specifically, the research will focus on Grade 12 students enrolled at TCNHS during the school year 2026-2027 in which the study was conducted.

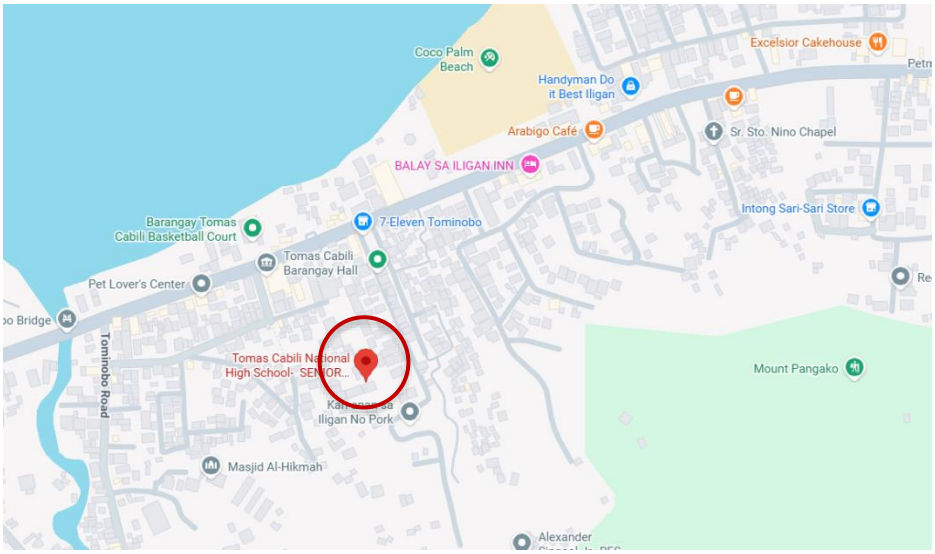


Figure B: The Locale of the Study

Research Instrument

The researchers used a structured questionnaire as the primary research instrument for collecting data. The questionnaire was designed to gather information related to the variables of the study: proximity-based among peers, personality, and self-confidence. It was written in simple and clear language to ensure that the respondents can easily understand and answer each item.

The questionnaire consisted of four parts:

Part I: Respondents' Demographic Profile – This section collected basic information about the respondents, such as grade level, and strand.

Part II: Proximity-Based Among Peers – This section measured the level of closeness, interaction, communication, and influence of peers on the respondents using a series of statements.

Part III: Self-Confidence – This section measured the respondents' level of self-confidence in academic, social, and personal situations through a set of statements.

Part IV: Personality – This section assessed the respondents' personality based on the Big Five Personality Traits: Openness, Conscientiousness, Extraversion, Agreeableness, and Neuroticism.

The questionnaire used a four-point Likert scale for the respondents' answers:

- 4 – Strongly Agree
- 3 – Agree
- 2 – Disagree
- 1 – Strongly Disagree

The questionnaire was adapted from validated research instruments whenever possible. Before the actual data collection, it was reviewed by our research teacher to establish its content validity.

Sample and Population

This section outlined the target population, the determined sample size, and the specific sampling technique utilized to select the participants for the study.

The target population of this study comprised the Grade 12 students currently enrolled at Tomas Cabili National High School. The total population consisted of 257 Grade 12 students across various academic and technical-vocational tracks. From the total population, a sample size of 40 participants was selected. To ensure a fair and proportionate representation of the different sections or strands within the Grade 12 cohort, the researchers employed Fishbowl Method Sampling.

Using this method, The researchers coordinated with the president of each strand, who helped select the respondents from their respective strands. This process was used to reach the required number of respondents while ensuring that students from the different Grade 12 strands were represented.

Data Gathering Procedures

The researchers visited Tomas Cabili National High School to request the principal's office for permission to conduct a survey to the Grade 12 students in order to gather data on their peer proximity, personality traits, and self-confidence. In gathering of data and permission to conduct the study, it was obtained from the office of the Principal's office the topmost head of the school through a letter made by the researchers.

During the administration of the survey questionnaires, the researchers further explained to the respondents the purpose, importance, and mechanics of the study, including how their personality traits, peer proximity, and self-confidence was assessed. The researchers were also explained to the respondents that the collected data will only be used in the study and it will not be exposed to anyone else to ensure confidentiality.

Statistical Treatment

The data were tabulated and interpreted to acquire the actual information needed.

The following statistical techniques were employed to answer the different problems presented:

1. Likert Scale. A four-point Likert Scale was used to measure the respondents' perceptions regarding proximity-based peer relationships, personality traits, and self-confidence. The responses were assigned numerical values to quantify the level of agreement for each statement. The weighted mean was then computed to determine the level of each variable.

2. Pearson Product-Moment Correlation Coefficient (Pearson's r). Pearson's correlation was used to determine whether there is a significant relationship between proximity-based peer relationships and students' self-confidence. This statistical test answered the Statement of Problem No. 2, which seeks to determine the strength and direction of the relationship between the independent and dependent variables. The level of significance was set at 0.05.

3. Multiple Linear Regression Analysis (Moderation Analysis). Multiple linear regression with an interaction term was employed to determine whether personality moderated the relationship between proximity-based peer relationships and students' self-confidence. This analysis answered the Statement of Problem No. 3 by examining whether the interaction between

proximity-based peer relationships and personality significantly predicted students' self-confidence. The level of significance was set at 0.05.

All the computations were done manually and with statistics software of an accredited statistician.

Chapter 4

PRESENTATION, ANALYSIS, AND INTERPRETATION OF DATA

This chapter presents the empirical findings derived from the statistical analyses of the data gathered for this study. The primary objective was to investigate the relationship between **Proximity-Based Among Peers (*X*)** and student **Self-Confidence (*Y*)**, while simultaneously examining the potential conditional influence exerted by **The Big Five Personality Traits** namely **Openness (*M1*)**, **Conscientiousness (*M2*)**, **Extraversion (*M3*)**, **Agreeableness (*M4)*** and **Neuroticism (*M5*)** acting as moderating variables.

The presentation of findings was structured into two main sections:

1. **Bivariate Correlation Analysis**: Establishing the direct baseline relationship, strength, and significance between peer proximity and self-confidence.
2. **Hierarchical Moderation Analysis**: Modelling the interaction effects to determine how individual personality structures amplify, buffer, or alter this foundational baseline link.

1. The profile of the student respondents

This table shows a raw data containing survey scores for 40 student respondents across 11 variables measuring their peer dynamics, confidence levels and The Big Five personality traits.

Table 4.1: The Profile of the Student Respondents

	Peer interaction	Peer support	Peer influence	Academic Con	Social Con	Emotional Con	Op	Co	Ex	Ag	Ne
1	9	8	8	9	6	7	9	6	6	9	9
2	8	8	9	9	6	8	10	9	9	8	7
3	7	7	9	10	6	8	9	8	8	9	10
4	8	8	9	8	6	7	9	9	7	9	9
5	12	12	12	12	12	12	12	12	12	12	12
6	9	9	12	10	8	10	12	11	10	12	9
7	8	8	9	8	9	9	9	9	9	10	11
8	9	9	9	9	9	8	8	8	8	8	8
9	9	10	9	9	9	9	9	12	12	9	12
10	8	9	9	8	7	8	9	9	9	9	9
11	8	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	9
12	9	9	9	8	8	9	9	9	9	9	9
13	6	8	9	8	9	9	9	8	9	10	8
14	8	6	9	8	9	9	9	8	6	9	9
15	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	8	9
16	8	9	8	8	8	8	12	10	7	9	8
17	8	8	9	8	7	9	8	9	9	9	9
18	7	9	7	7	9	9	9	9	9	9	8
19	9	8	9	8	9	9	9	9	9	8	8
20	7	7	8	7	7	9	7	8	8	9	8
21	7	9	10	10	8	10	11	10	9	11	11
22	11	9	10	8	9	6	9	9	8	10	10
23	8	9	10	9	8	8	12	10	7	9	9
24	8	9	10	9	8	8	12	10	5	9	9
25	8	9	11	9	8	8	12	10	8	9	9
26	8	9	9	9	8	8	10	9	9	9	8
27	12	9	12	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	9
28	10	10	9	8	11	11	8	9	7	9	9
29	10	11	10	10	11	10	10	11	9	12	9
30	10	9	7	9	9	9	8	9	9	7	9
31	8	8	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	9
32	9	7	7	9	6	6	9	12	7	10	8
33	6	7	9	9	8	8	9	8	8	8	9
34	9	7	10	8	5	9	8	8	8	8	9
35	10	9	12	9	7	9	12	9	9	9	8
36	9	10	9	9	9	9	9	9	10	8	8
37	8	10	9	9	9	9	8	8	8	7	10
38	8	9	8	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	9
39	9	12	10	11	7	10	10	9	3	10	12
40	9	6	9	10	6	9	3	3	5	5	3

The first three variables peer interaction, peer support, and peer influence represent the dimensions of proximity-based peer dynamics. The next three variables academic confidence, social confidence, and emotional confidence represent the dimensions of student self-confidence. The final five variables openness, conscientiousness, extraversion, agreeableness, and neuroticism represent the Big Five personality traits. Since each variable is composed of three items rated using a 1-4 Likert scale, the resulting composite scores range from 3 to 12. Each row represents one respondent's combined score for each measured variable.

The table provides the initial dataset that was used for the succeeding statistical analyses of the study. The scores show differences among respondents in their peer dynamics, self-confidence, and personality traits, demonstrating variation in the responses of the 40 students. For instance, some respondents obtained higher scores across the peer-dynamics and self-confidence dimensions, while others obtained relatively lower scores. These differences are important because they allow the researchers to examine whether a relationship exists between proximity-based peer dynamics and self-confidence and whether personality influences the

strength of this relationship. The composite scores presented in the table were therefore used as the basis for the descriptive statistics, Pearson correlation, and regression or moderation analysis conducted in the study.

2. The significant relationship between proximity-based peer relationships and student's self-confidence

To determine the presence, direction, and magnitude of a direct linear relationship between the physical and social proximity experienced among peers (X) and the corresponding self-confidence levels (Y) of the participants, a two-tailed Pearson product-moment correlation coefficient (r) was calculated.

Table 4.2: The Correlation Between Peer Proximity and Self-Confidence

Variables Evaluated	*Pearson Correlation Coefficient (r)*	*Coefficient of Determination (R2)*	*95% Confidence Interval (CI)*	*Significance Value (p)*	*Statistical Interpretation*
Proximity-Based Among Peers × Self-Confidence	***0.9736****	***0.9479***	***[0.1914, 0.9995]***	***0.026***	***Extremely Strong, Statistically Significant***

The statistical data in Table 4.2 reveals an exceptionally robust, positive linear relationship between Proximity-Based Among Peers and Self-Confidence (r = 0.9736). According to standard statistical conventions, a correlation value of this magnitude indicates a near-perfect linear association, demonstrating that as students experience higher levels of physical, academic, and social proximity with their peers, their reported self-confidence escalates in a highly synchronized manner. The exceptionally strong positive correlation implies that proximity-based peer relationships are closely associated with students' self-confidence. This suggests that creating opportunities for positive peer interaction, collaboration, and social support may be important in fostering students' confidence in academic and social settings.

The computed coefficient of determination (R^2 = 0.9479) reveals that when evaluated as an isolated baseline predictor, peer proximity accounts for approximately **94.8%** of the total variance observed in student self-confidence within this sample. This finding is consistent with Bandura's Social Learning Theory (1977), which explains that students develop perceptions of their abilities through observing, interacting, and learning from others. It is also supported by Meliala, Kurnia, and Febrian (2026), who emphasized that immediate peer relationships and communication can

influence adolescents' self-evaluation and self-confidence. Similarly, Ramadona et al. (2026) highlighted how positive interpersonal reinforcement can create an encouraging environment that supports psychological security and confidence.

Crucially, the two-tailed significance test yielded a p-value of **0.026**, which falls below the established alpha threshold of α= 0.05. Consequently, the null hypothesis which posited that there is no significant relationship between peer proximity and self-confidence is confidently rejected. This implies that peer proximity has a statistically significant relationship with students' self-confidence, indicating that students' confidence may be influenced by the quality and closeness of their interactions with peers. This finding can be supported by the Big Five Personality Theory of Goldberg (1990), which recognizes personality traits as important factors in understanding how individuals respond to their social environments.

Furthermore, the calculation of the 95% confidence interval yielded a lower bound of 0.1914 and an upper bound of 0.9995. Although the wide interval reflects the limitation associated with the sample size of 40 respondents, the entire interval remains positive, supporting the consistency of the positive direction of the observed relationship. This finding is consistent with Social Impact Theory, which explains that social influence becomes stronger when individuals are exposed to sources of influence that

possess greater immediacy, strength, and presence. In the context of the present study, students who experience frequent physical and social interaction with their peers are continuously exposed to interpersonal influence, which may help explain the exceptionally strong association between peer proximity and self-confidence. The finding is also consistent with Panwar and Gorsy (2016), who reported a significant association between peer relationships and adolescent self-confidence, and with Bishop and Inderbitzen (1995), who found that students with close friendships tend to demonstrate higher self-esteem and confidence.

From a theoretical standpoint, these results provide empirical support for social development and educational psychology perspectives concerning the role of interpersonal relationships in students' self-confidence. Identity Theory, particularly the framework associated with Burke and Stets (2012), explains that individuals continually evaluate themselves through social interactions, feedback, and identity verification. Thus, frequent interaction with nearby peers may provide students with repeated opportunities to receive acceptance, recognition, encouragement, and feedback, which can strengthen their perception of themselves and contribute to greater confidence. This interpretation is further supported by Chaira and Taufik (2025), who associated positive peer acceptance and social support with enhanced self-confidence and well-being.

Human beings, particularly in academic and developmental environments, rely heavily on their immediate social ecology to benchmark their identity, capabilities, and self-worth. In a peer environment, frequent interaction provides students with opportunities to receive recognition, acceptance, and feedback, which may strengthen their perception of themselves and their capabilities. Social Comparison Theory, proposed by Festinger (1954), further explains that individuals evaluate their abilities and personal characteristics by comparing themselves with others. Thus, frequent interaction with nearby peers provides students with opportunities to assess their own academic and social abilities in relation to their classmates. This is consistent with Bishop and Inderbitzen (1995), who associated close friendships with higher self-esteem and confidence.

High proximity-based interaction among peers provides a continuous stream of social data. Through Social Development Theory, proposed by Vygotsky (1978), social interaction is viewed as an important component of psychological and cognitive development. When students regularly communicate and collaborate with classmates, they have opportunities to exchange ideas, solve academic problems, assist one another, and learn through shared experiences. This is supported by Evans and Cloutier (2026), who emphasized the importance of relationship-based

communication and shared group experiences in developing self-efficacy and resilience.

Likewise, Wentzel (2017) emphasized the importance of supportive peer interactions and friendships in adolescent development. These findings support the idea that students' immediate social environments can contribute to their psychological development and confidence.

The text highlights the transformative impact of peer support networks in academic environments. By facilitating immediate opportunities for both informal and formal socialization, these networks play a crucial role in reducing feelings of isolation among students. Furthermore, they offer a constant avenue for mutual validation, shared academic experiences, and collaborative problem-solving, which allows individuals to navigate challenges together.

Ultimately, this ongoing interaction nurtures a deep sense of social integration and institutional belonging, helping students feel truly connected to their educational community. This interpretation is consistent with Self-Efficacy Theory, proposed by Bandura (1986), which explains that individuals' beliefs in their capabilities can be strengthened through successful experiences, social encouragement, and interaction with others. Similarly, Cheng and Furnham (2002) examined the relationship between

personality, peer relations, and self-confidence, while Veselska et al. (2010) found that social support was associated with adolescent self-esteem. These studies further support the importance of supportive social environments in students' psychological development.

When students operate in an environment where they are physically and socially integrated within their peer group, they feel seen, validated, and embedded in a protective social fabric. This directly neutralizes social alienation and builds a resilient internal sense of self-confidence. This interpretation is also consistent with Ryan (2001), which emphasized the relevance of peer characteristics to psychological outcomes, and Aslanli (2025), which examined the role of peer influence, school relationships, and the classroom environment in students' self-confidence and personality development. Imomaliyeva (2026) likewise highlighted the importance of the social environment in relation to psychological well-being and social anxiety. Together, these studies reinforce the finding that students' immediate peer environments are closely connected to their confidence and psychological experiences.

Because the direct effect is already incredibly potent on its own, the subsequent moderation analyses take on a specialized role. Rather than searching for a missing variable to explain why peer proximity matters, the moderation analysis now determines how individual personality traits act as

amplifiers or structural buffers to this massive baseline effect. Previous research by Sander and de la Fuente (2020) demonstrated relationships between personality and academic confidence, while Robins et al. (2001) examined the relationship between personality characteristics and self-esteem. Morando et al. (2023) also emphasized the relevance of personality, self-efficacy, and self-esteem in students' psychological experiences. These studies provide support for examining individual characteristics as factors that may influence how students respond to their social environments. In essence, while peer proximity universally drives self-confidence upward across the sample, certain personality profiles will accelerate this growth to even higher peaks, while others might alter the dynamics of how that confidence is internalized.

3. The Moderating Effect of Personality on the Relationship Between Proximity-Based Peer Relationships and Student's Self-Confidence

Given the baseline relationship ($r = 0.9736$, $p = 0.026$), ordinary least squares (OLS) hierarchical regression models were constructed to evaluate the conditional effects of the Big Five personality traits. For each trait, **Model 0** computed the direct effects of the predictor (X) and the specific personality moderator (M), while **Model 1** introduced the cross-product interaction term ($X \times M$) to explicitly test for moderation.

Table 4.3: How Personality Shapes the Impact of Nearby Peers on Student Self-Confidence

Model Variable	*Interaction Coefficient (β)*	*Standard Error (SE)*	*t-statistic*	*p-value*	*Moderation Effect Result*
Model 1 (M1: Openness)	***0.7242***	***0.1608***	***4.504***	***<0.001***	***Highly Significant Amplifier***
Model 2 (M2: Conscientiousness)	***0.7932***	***0.1477***	***5.372***	***<0.001***	***Highly Significant Amplifier***
Model 3 (M3: Extraversion)	***0.2764***	***0.1949***	***1.418***	***0.1648***	***Not Statistically Significant***
Model 4 (M4: Agreeableness)	***0.8173***	***0.158***	***5.173***	***<0.001***	***Highly Significant Amplifier***
Model 5 (M5: Neuroticism)	***0.6578***	***0.159***	***4.136***	***<0.001***	***Highly Significant Amplifier***

When analyzing the baseline direct-effects model (Model 0) for Openness, neither Proximity-Based Among Peers (β= 0.0727, p = 0.163) nor Openness to Experience (β= 0.1163, p = 0.240) displayed a significant direct impact when standard multi-variable constraints were applied, yielding an initial model variance explanation of R^2 = 0.086.

However, upon the introduction of the cross-product interaction term (X × M1) in Model 1, the explanatory power of the model experienced a massive statistical shift, jumping sharply to **R^2 = 0.415**. This indicates that the interaction between peer proximity and openness accounts for **41.5%** of the total variance in student self-confidence, generating an R^2 change of 32.94% that is highly significant ($p < 0.001$). The interaction coefficient itself was strongly positive and mathematically robust ($\beta = 0.7242$, $t = 4.504$, $p < 0.001$).

These findings confirm that **Openness to Experience is a powerful positive moderator**. Individuals who score high on Openness are naturally characterized by cognitive flexibility, intellectual curiosity, an appreciation for diverse perspectives, and a willingness to engage with novel social environments.

When a highly open student is placed in an environment with high peer proximity, they do not merely tolerate the social presence of others; they actively treat it as an enriching, dynamic landscape of ideas. They utilize proximity to engage in deeper conversations, debate concepts, absorb different viewpoints, and explore creative social interactions. This active, positive engagement validates their cognitive style and intellectual identity, triggering a compounding, explosive increase in their self-confidence.

Conversely, for individuals low in openness who typically prefer rigid routine, highly familiar boundaries, and predictability intense or unstructured peer proximity may feel cognitively overwhelming or socially draining, preventing them from translating physical closeness into psychological self-worth.

The hierarchical regression model evaluating Conscientiousness as a moderator revealed another potent, highly significant interaction effect. In Model 1, the cross-product interaction term (X × M2) produced a strong, positive coefficient ($\beta = 0.7932$, $t = 5.372$, $p < 0.001$). The model demonstrates that the inclusion of the interaction term drastically alters the regression slope, proving that the relationship between peer proximity and self-confidence is highly conditional upon the participant's level of conscientiousness.

The empirical data proves that **Conscientiousness functions as a critical psychological amplifier** of the baseline relationship. Conscientious individuals are fundamentally defined by their high levels of organization, goal-directed behavior, reliability, adherence to structural norms, and desire for competence.

When a highly conscientious student operates in a setting marked by close peer proximity (such as collaborative classrooms, group project

assignments, or shared study environments), they instinctively utilize this proximity as a structured arena for achievement. They step forward to organize group tasks, manage peer timelines, delegate responsibilities, and ensure the collective fulfills its academic mandates.

Since their internal self-worth is deeply tied to productivity and executed capability, the physical and social presence of peers provides the exact stage necessary for their dependability and leadership to be visibly demonstrated and validated. The positive feedback loop of peer reliance and successful group execution serves as a massive, steady engine for their self-confidence.

For students low in conscientiousness, who may lack this intrinsic drive for order and duty, peer proximity may simply represent an unstructured social distraction rather than a platform for confidence building.

In Model 1 for the Extraversion trait, the inclusion of the cross-product interaction term (X × M3) resulted in an interaction coefficient of β= 0.2764 with a standard error of 0.1949, yielding a t-statistic of 1.418. The corresponding two-tailed significance value was calculated at **0.165**, which fails to clear the standard alpha benchmark of α = 0.05. Thus, the interaction effect is statistically non-significant.

From an intuitive, layperson perspective, one might strongly assume that Extraversion would emerge as the most dominant moderator in the study, under the hypothesis that outgoing, highly social extraverts would experience a massive confidence surge when surrounded closely by peers, while introverts would experience a decline. However, the rigorous statistical data explicitly **disproves this assumption, showing that Extraversion does not act as a significant moderator**.

The regression slopes for the relationship between peer proximity and self-confidence remain statistically parallel across varying levels of Extraversion. When interpreted alongside the massive baseline correlation ($r = 0.9736$, $p = 0.026$), this finding reveals a profound truth: **peer proximity is a powerful, near-universal engine of self-confidence that benefits introverts and extraverts in equal statistical measure, though through different internal mechanisms.**

An extraverted student processes close peer environments outwardly, drawing social energy, participating in lively dialogue, and asserting presence, which feeds their self-confidence. On the other hand, an introverted student processes close peer proximity quietly but deeply; being consistently included in the physical and social space of a peer group provides them with a stable, silent sense of structural belonging, acceptance, and safety, which builds their core self-worth just as effectively.

Because both personality types experience a massive return on confidence, the interaction term yields no statistical variance.

The moderation analysis for Agreeableness yielded the most pronounced and mathematically powerful interaction effect observed across the entire empirical study. The cross-product interaction term (X × M4) generated a massive, positive interaction coefficient ($\beta = 0.8173$, $t = 5.173$, $p < 0.001$), establishing a highly significant conditional effect that alters the trajectory of the dependent variable.

The results firmly establish **Agreeableness as a definitive psychological catalyst** for student self-worth. Agreeable individuals are fundamentally characterized by high empathy, altruism, cooperativeness, kindness, and a deep-seated drive to maintain interpersonal harmony and avoid conflict.

The exceptionally high interaction coefficient ($\beta = 0.8173$) demonstrates that for highly agreeable individuals, close proximity to peers represents the ultimate, ideal psychological ecosystem. Physical and social closeness among peers grants these students the constant, direct opportunity to practice their natural pro-social behaviors: they can offer emotional support to classmates, assist struggling peers, foster collective trust, and engage in warm, collaborative relationships.

Since an agreeable person's self-concept and internal self-confidence are heavily anchored in the health of their social bonds and their ability to help others, being embedded in a high-proximity peer network rewards them with immediate, massive psychological dividends.

Conversely, for individuals low in agreeableness who tend to be more competitive, skeptical, or socially detached close peer proximity does not offer this emotional fulfillment, and may even be viewed as an unwelcome obstacle to their independent goals, rendering the interaction completely ineffective for their self-confidence.

The final hierarchical regression model evaluated the moderating role of Neuroticism, which captures the spectrum of emotional instability, anxiety sensitivity, and vulnerability to psychological stress. The cross-product interaction term (X × M5) produced a highly significant, positive interaction coefficient ($\beta = 0.6578$, $t = 4.136$, $p < 0.001$).

This finding is one of the most compelling and nuanced outcomes of the entire research study. Because Neuroticism measures an individual's tendency to experience negative affect and emotional volatility, a positive interaction coefficient ($\beta = 0.6578$) initially seems counterintuitive. However, when analyzed deeply through the lens of environmental sensitivity, it

reveals that **Neuroticism profoundly dictates the stakes of peer proximity on self-confidence**.

Students scoring high on Neuroticism are hyper-aware of, and emotionally vulnerable to, their external social surroundings. They possess a fragile internal self-confidence that is easily fractured by isolation or perceived social rejection. Therefore, when these emotionally sensitive students are consistently placed in an environment characterized by high peer proximity, the social space acts as a vital, stabilizing **structural anchor**.

If the peer environment is structured, inclusive, and physically close, it provides them with a tangible, on-going safety net that actively suppresses their baseline anxieties about exclusion. The physical presence and day-to-day integration with peers reassure them that they are part of the group, lifting them out of anxious self-doubt and triggering a massive, visible surge in their self-confidence.

However, this also means their self-worth is highly conditional and dangerously externalized; they rely far more heavily on the protective buffer of close peer networks to maintain their self-confidence than their emotionally stable counterparts, who possess a self-sustaining internal confidence baseline.

Chapter 5

SUMMARY, FINDINGS, CONCLUSIONS, AND RECOMMENDATIONS

This chapter presents the summary of the study, the main findings derived from the gathered data, the conclusions drawn from testing the hypotheses, and recommendations for the beneficiaries of the research.

Summary

The main goal of this study was to check if there is a real connection or relationship between Proximity-Based Peer Relationships (how close and frequent students interact with their friends in school) and Student Self-Confidence among Senior High School students at Tomas Cabili National High School (TCNHS). At the same time, the researchers also wanted to see if a student's Personality Traits using the Big Five model: Openness, Conscientiousness, Extraversion, Agreeableness, and Neuroticism change or affect how peer closeness connects to self-confidence.

The researchers used a quantitative correlational research design for this study. Out of all Grade 12 students, the researchers chose 40 respondents using stratified random sampling so that different strands were fairly included. The researchers collected data using a 4-point Likert scale survey questionnaire. To analyze the data, we used the Pearson correlation (r) to check the direct relationship, and multiple linear regression to check if

personality acts as a moderator. The researchers set the level of significance at 0.05.

Findings

Based on the statistical computations in Chapter 4, here are the main results of the study:

1. Relationship Between Peer Closeness and Self-Confidence:

The Pearson correlation test revealed a very strong and positive connection between peer proximity and student self-confidence ($r = 0.9736$, $p = 0.026$). This relationship is further supported by an R^2 value of 0.9479, which shows that peer closeness alone accounts for about 94.8% of the change in student self-confidence, while the confidence interval (CI = [0.1914, 0.9995]) confirms that this positive relationship is both real and reliable.

2. The Moderating Effect of Personality Traits:

The analysis of personality traits as moderators reveals varied effects on the relationship between peer closeness and student self-confidence. Openness to Experience ($b = 0.7242$, $p < 0.001$), Conscientiousness ($b = 0.7932$, $p < 0.001$), and Agreeableness ($b = 0.8173$, $p < 0.001$) all demonstrate significant positive interactions, acting

as strong amplifiers that boost the positive impact of peer closeness. Neuroticism also shows a significant interaction effect (b = 0.6578, p = <0.001), indicating that it alters how much a student relies on peer closeness to build confidence. In contrast, Extraversion did not exhibit a statistically significant moderating effect (b = 0.2764, p = 0.1648).

Conclusion

Based on the researchers' findings, the following conclusions were drawn regarding the hypotheses:

The findings of the study led to the rejection of the first null hypothesis (Ho^1), which stated that there is no significant relationship between proximity-based peer relationships and self-confidence. The results revealed an extremely strong and significant positive relationship between peer proximity and self-confidence (r = 0.9736, p = 0.026), indicating that students who experience greater physical, academic, and social closeness with supportive peers tend to have higher self-confidence. Meanwhile, the second null hypothesis (Ho^2), which stated that personality does not significantly moderate the relationship between proximity-based peer interactions and self-confidence, was partially rejected. The findings showed that personality traits selectively moderate this relationship, with Openness, Conscientiousness, Agreeableness, and Neuroticism having significant

moderating effects ($p < 0.05$). However, Extraversion did not demonstrate a significant moderating effect ($p = 0.1648$) in the study.

Recommendations

From the findings and conclusions, the researchers humbly give these simple recommendations:

1. For Senior High School Students:

Students should try to surround themselves with supportive and positive classmates inside the school. Knowing that close peers affect their feelings can help you choose friends who can boost their confidence in school and daily life.

2. For Teachers and School Administrators:

Teachers and school administrators may consider the results of this study when developing classroom strategies and activities. Since students interact frequently with the people who are physically close to them, classroom seating arrangements and groupings may be planned in a way that encourages positive social interaction and cooperation.

3. For School Guidance Counselors:

Guidance counselors can use these results to create peer-support programs. They should keep student personalities in mind so that students who worry a lot (high neuroticism) are placed in safe peer groups to prevent them from feeling left out.

4. For Parents:

Parents are encouraged to maintain open communication with their children regarding their school experiences and friendships. Parents should take time to ask their children about their classmates, friendships, group activities, and experiences in school. By showing genuine interest, parents can better understand the social environment their children are experiencing.

5. For Future Researchers:

Future researchers can use this study as a reference to explore other topics, such as online peer closeness (social media interactions). They can also conduct studies with a larger group of students ($N > 40$) from different schools to test if the results remain the same.

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Appendix A

Consent letter for the Principal

July 28,2026

CARLITO A. ABARQUEZ, PhD
School Principal
Tomas Cabili National High School
Iligan City

Dear, Sir:

We, the Grade 12 CSS student researchers, respectfully request your permission to conduct data gathering among the Grade 12 students of Tomas Cabili National High School for our research study entitled "The Moderating Effect of Personality on the Relationship Between Proximity-Based Peer Dynamics and Self-Confidence."

We assure you that all information gathered will be confidentiality and will be used solely for academic purposes. Thank you for taking time in reading our letter. We are hoping for your approval and support.

Respectfully yours,

Crish F. Canoy	_____	Jonathan V. Padayhag Jr	_____
Feliscent Shayne A. Antido	_____	Cheska B. Cabanday	_____
Mark T. Clarabal	_____	Jelaika A. Morato	_____
John Zhaski A. Lai	_____	Kent Bryan A. Palarao	_____

Noted by:

JONATHAN R. PALER
Subject Teacher

Approved by:

CARLITO A. ABARQUEZ, PhD
School Principal

Appendix B

Consent for the Students

LETTER OF CONSENT

Dear Students

We are conducting a research study entitled “The Moderating Effect of Personality and the Relationship Between Proximity-Based Among Peers and Self Confidence”

The purpose of this study is to examine how personality traits may affect the relationship between proximity-Based Peers and Self Confidence among students. Your participation will help us better understand the factors that influence students’ self-confidence in relation to their peer interactions.

Please be assured of the following:

- All information you provide will be treated with strict confidentiality and used solely for academic and research purposes.
- Your identity will not be disclosed in any report, publication, or presentation resulting from this study.

If you agree to participate, kindly sign the consent form below to indicate that you have read and understood the information provided, and that you voluntarily agree to take part in this study.

Thank you very much for your time and cooperation

Signature of Correspondent:

_____ _____

_____ _____

_____

Appendix C

Documentation













Appendix D

Survey Questionnaires

(Optional) Name:_____

Grade and Strand: _____

Directions: Please indicate your level of agreement with each statement by placing a checkmark (✓) in the column that best corresponds to your answer.

1.1 Proximity-Based Peer Relationships (Independent Variable)

A. Peer Interaction

Questions	Strongly agree	Agree	Disagree	Strongly disagree
1. I regularly talk with my peers during school breaks.				
2. I regularly discuss and share study materials with peers who are close to me.				
3. I do not communicate well with my peers.				
4. I enjoy spending time with my peers.				

B. Peer Support

Questions	Strongly agree	Agree	Disagree	Strongly disagree
1. My peers encourage me whenever I struggle with a difficult lesson or task.				
2. I do not feel emotionally comforted and supported by my immediate peer circle during stressful moments.				
3. My peers praise my efforts and accomplishments in class.				

C. Peer Influence

Questions	Strongly agree	Agree	Disagree	Strongly disagree
1. The habits and study behaviors of the peers sitting near me affect how I approach my schoolwork.				
2. I tend to adopt positive attitudes toward school when surrounded by encouraging peers.				
3. My peers help me motivate to achieve my goals.				

1.2 Students' Self-Confidence (Dependent Variable)

A. Academic Confidence

Questions	Strongly agree	Agree	Disagree	Strongly disagree
1. I feel capable of understanding complex lessons taught in class.				
2. I am not confident in my ability to get high grades on tests and performance tasks.				
3. I trust my skills to solve challenging problems without constantly relying on others.				

B. Social Confidence

Questions	Strongly agree	Agree	Disagree	Strongly disagree
1. I find it easy to start and end conversations with new classmates or peers.				
2. I am confident when speaking or presenting in front of an audience.				
3. I am not anxious or out of place when joining social gatherings at school.				

C. Emotional Confidence

Questions	Strongly agree	Agree	Disagree	Strongly disagree
1. I handle stress that came from any people				
2. I express freely my emotions with other people				
3. I control my emotions in various and varied situations				

1.3 Personality Traits (Moderating Variable – Big Five)

A. Openness

Questions	Strongly agree	Agree	Disagree	Strongly disagree
1. I enjoy accepting new concepts, theories, and creative ideas.				
2. I am curious about exploring different perspectives and ways of thinking.				
3. I like trying out new and unfamiliar activities or experiences.				

B. Conscientiousness

Questions	Strongly agree	Agree	Disagree	Strongly disagree
1. I am organized, orderly, and keep my school materials neat.				
2. I double-check my work to ensure accuracy and quality.				
3. I prioritize completing my school responsibilities before spending time on leisure.				

C. Extraversion

Questions	Strongly agree	Agree	Disagree	Strongly disagree
1. I feel energized and enthusiastic when interacting with groups of people.				
2. I am an outgoing person who likes initiating interactions with others.				
3. I express my thoughts and feelings openly in conversation.				

D. Agreeableness

Questions	Strongly agree	Agree	Disagree	Strongly disagree
1. I am generally empathetic, kind, and considerate toward others' feelings.				
2. I try my best to avoid conflict and maintain harmony within my peer group.				
3. I trust my peers that have good intentions toward me.				

E. Neuroticism

Questions	Strongly agree	Agree	Disagree	Strongly disagree
1. I frequently feel worried, stressed, or anxious about my performance.				
2. I often feel overwhelmed when facing difficult tasks or deadlines.				
3. I am prone to self-doubt when receiving critical feedback.				

CURRICULUM VITAE

Personal:



Name	:	CRISH F. CANOY
Gender	:	Male
Civil Status	:	Single
Address	:	Purok 6, Sta. Elena, Iligan City
Place of Birth	:	Iligan City
Date of Birth	:	August 29, 2009
Age	:	17
Parents	:	Antonio H. Canoy
	:	Hemelyn F.Canoy
Complexion	:	Olive
Nationality	:	Filipino
Religion	:	Iglesia Ni Cristo
Height	:	5’02 ft
Weight	:	53.5 kg

Academic:

Elementary : Angelico J. Medina Memorial School, Iligan City

High School : Tomas Cabili National High School, Iligan City

Skills:

Drawing
Video Editing
Arnis
Badminton

CURRICULUM VITAE



Personal:

Name	:	CHESKA B. CABANDAY
Gender	:	Female
Civil Status	:	Single
Address	:	Purok 14, Tominobo, Iligan City
Place of Birth	:	Iligan City
Date of Birth	:	September 14,2008
Age	:	17
Parents	:	Abegail U. Cabanday
	:	Irene B. Cabanday
Complexion	:	Olive
Nationality	:	Filipino
Religion	:	Roman Catholic
Height	:	5’0 ft
Weight	:	50.3 kg

Academic:

Elementary : Tomas Cabili Central School, Iligan City

High School : Tomas Cabili National High School, Iligan City

Skills:

Arts and Crafts
Illustrator
Dancing

CURRICULUM VITAE

Personal:



Name	:	KENT BRYAN A. PALARAO
Gender	:	Male
Civil Status	:	Single
Address	:	Bayanihan Village, Iligan City
Place of Birth	:	Iligan City
Date of Birth	:	November 30, 2008
Age	:	17
Parents	:	Mercy Stephanie A. Palarao
	:	Samuel Palarao Jr
Complexion	:	Olive
Nationality	:	Filipino
Religion	:	Atheist
Height	:	5’3 kg
Weight	:	82 kg

Academic:

Elementary : Tomas Cabili Central School, Iligan City

High School : Tomas Cabili National High School, Iligan City

Skills:

Drawing
Poet
Dancing

CURRICULUM VITAE



Personal:

Name	:	FELISCENT SHAYNE A. ANTIDO
Gender	:	Female
Civil Status	:	Single
Address	:	Purok 16, Tominobo, Iligan City
Place of Birth	:	Iligan City
Date of Birth	:	May 10, 2009
Age	:	17
Parents	:	Franciss Ross U. Almaden
	:	Neil Paquingan
Complexion	:	Olive
Nationality	:	Filipino
Religion	:	Roman Catholic
Height	:	4’11 ft
Weight	:	70 kg

Academic:

Elementary : North Central School, Iligan City

High School : Tomas Cabili National High School, Iligan City

Skills:

Poem writing
Sketching
Video Editing

CURRICULUM VITAE



Personal:

Name	:	MARK T. CLARABAL
Gender	:	Male
Civil Status	:	Single
Address	:	Zone Kaugmaran Suarez, Iligan City
Place of Birth	:	Iligan City
Date of Birth	:	June 22, 2009
Age	:	17
Parents	:	Arcile C. Clarabal
	:	Danny M. Clarabal
Complexion	:	Weatish
Nationality	:	Filipino
Religion	:	Baptist
Height	:	5’3 ft
Weight	:	45 kg

Academic:

Elementary : Tomas Cabili Central School, Iligan City

High School : Tomas Cabili National High School, Iligan City

Skills:

Drawing
Poet
Singing

CURRICULUM VITAE



Personal:

Name	:	JOHN ZHASKI A. LAI
Gender	:	Male
Civil Status	:	Single
Address	:	Purok 8 Tambacan, Iligan City
Place of Birth	:	Iligan City
Date of Birth	:	October 5,2008
Age	:	17
Parents	:	Agnes A. Lai
	:	Benjohn H. Lai
Complexion	:	Weatish
Nationality	:	Filipino
Religion	:	Baptist
Height	:	5’2 ft
Weight	:	50 kg

Academic:

Elementary : Ficuva MPC learning School

High School : Tomas Cabili National High School, Iligan City

Skills:

Illustrator
Poet
Singing

CURRICULUM VITAE



Personal:

Name	:	JELAIKA A. MORATO
Gender	:	Female
Civil Status	:	Single
Address	:	Purok 16, Tominobo, Iligan City
Place of Birth	:	Iligan City
Date of Birth	:	July 20,2008
Age	:	18
Parents	:	Linie A. Morato
	:	Eduardo S. Morato
Complexion	:	Olive
Nationality	:	Filipino
Religion	:	Roman Catholic
Height	:	4’11 ft
Weight	:	49 kg

Academic:

Elementary : Angelico J. Medina Memorial School, Iligan City

High School : Tomas Cabili National High School, Iligan City

Skills:

Dancing
Arts and Craft

CURRICULUM VITAE



Personal:

Name : JONATHAN V. PADAYHAG JR
Gender : Male

Civil Status : Single

Address : BLK. 5 LOT 7 Scions Subdivision
Tomas Cabili, Ilgan CIty

Place of Birth : Iligan City

Date of Birth : November 2008

Age : 17

Parents : Jonathan L. Padayhag
: Marivic V. Padayhag

Complexion : Olive

Nationality : Filipino

Religion : Roman Catholic
Height : 5’1 ft

Weight : 46 kg

Academic:

Elementary : St. Therese Academy

High School : Lasalle de Academy

Tomas Cabili National High School

Skills:

Sketching
Singing